



Web Origami

Complements HTML and CSS so you can make an expressive site you understand

[Origami home](#)[Conceptual model](#)[Origami comics](#)

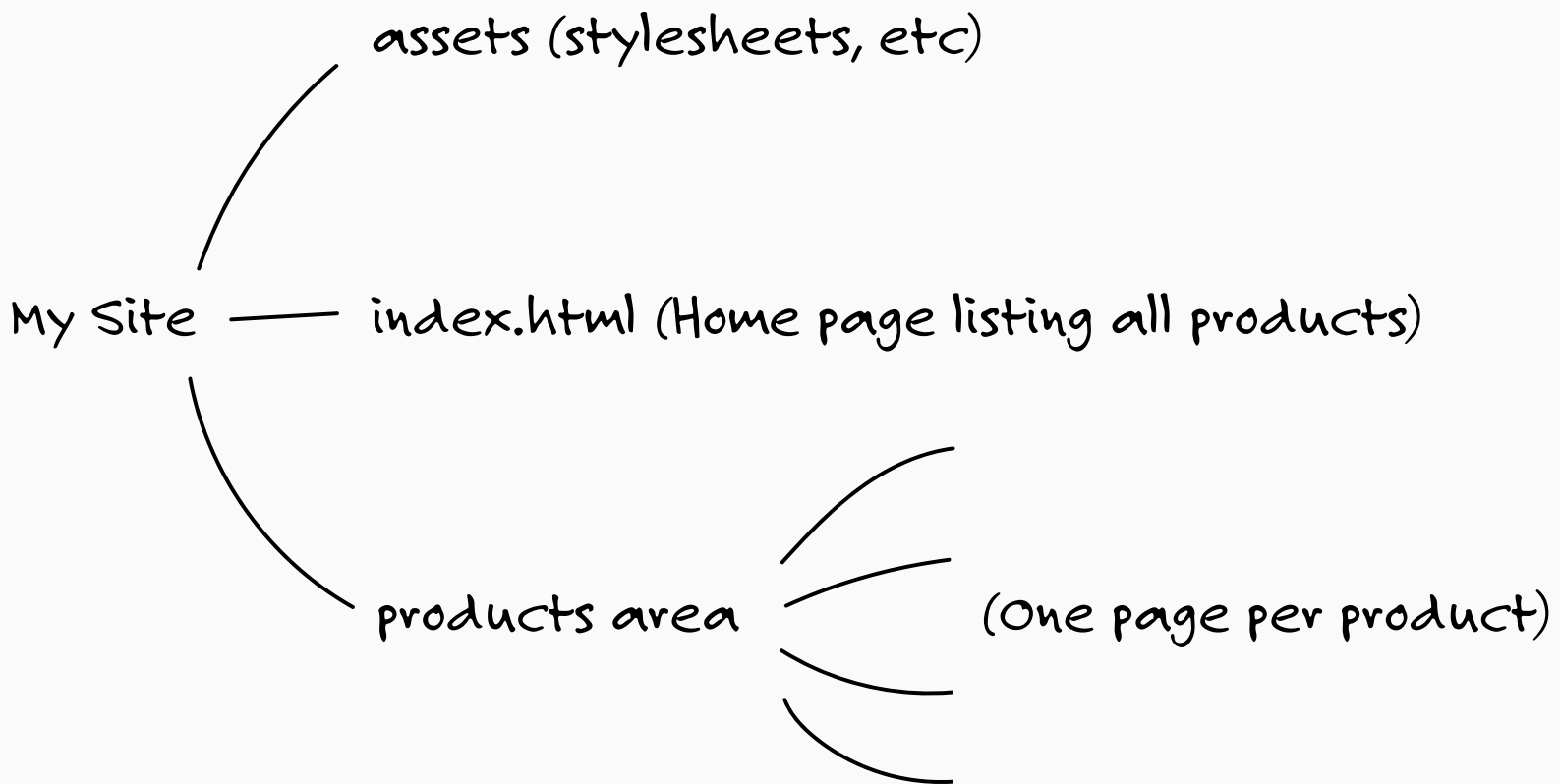
Web Origami is a system for creating sites that complements your understanding of HTML and CSS with the ability to concisely define the structure and content of the site you want.

Everybody has something to say, and the web is a great place to say it, but creating interesting sites can be hard or expensive. Standard HTML and CSS let you define individual pages, but it's hard to efficiently create a bunch of pages and organize them into a coherent site.

Origami is designed for you: someone who wants to make a site for yourself or a small organization, who can write some HTML and CSS, who wants to understand how their site is put together. Maybe you're not a professional developer — or you are, but want to build sites more interesting sites more quickly.

The core idea is to describe the site you want at a high level as concisely as possible. If you can sketch your site like this:

[Language](#)[CLI](#)[Builtins](#)[Library](#)[Pattern](#)



then you can turn that into a small Origami program that orchestrates the creation of your site:

```
{  
  // Stylesheets, etc.  
  assets/  
  
  // Create a home page listing all the products  
  index.html = index.ori(products.yaml)  
  
  // Create a page for each product  
  products = Tree.map(products.yaml, products.ori)  
}
```

Origami lets you describe how you want to transform your data and files into HTML and the other resources for your site. You can create many things without complex programming: a full-text search feature, RSS feeds for blogs, and so on.

A high-level site definition is enough to let you immediately view and iterate on your site without complex build tools. When you're ready to publish, Origami turns your site into a collection of plain files you can deploy wherever you want, often for free.

Aspects

Web Origami includes these tools and ideas:

- The [Origami dialect of JavaScript](#) lets you concisely define a site or other structured using formulas similar to those in a spreadsheet.
- The [ori command-line interface](#) (CLI) lets you use Origami expressions in a command terminal to manipulate files or get resources out of an Origami site in the command line. The CLI is also useful as a general tool in its own right for working with JavaScript in the shell.
- The [built-in functions](#) let you perform a number of common site development tasks in the Origami language or JavaScript.
- The [async-tree library](#) lets JavaScript programmers use core Origami features in JavaScript applications.
- The [conceptual pattern](#) at the foundation of it all lets you represent a wide variety of data types as tree structures that can be easily traversed and transformed. There's no code at this level; you can use the ideas in any project.

➤ View some [example sites](#)

➤ Make a basic blog in the [tutorial](#)

Latest comic

The [Origami Comics](#) area presents graphical introductions to Origami uses and features.

Community

If you'd like to ask questions, visit the [Web Origami chat room](#). You can view the chat without an account.

If you're interested in trying Origami in a friendly setting, you can participate in a guided playtest and share your feedback. Or join a pair programming session to use these new techniques and tools to collaboratively implement a site. Contact [Jan Miksovsky](#).